

INTERNATIONAL news

Nvidia to build chip factories in Japan

Headquartered in Santa Clara, California, Nvidia has announced its intention to establish semiconductor factories in Japan, amidst the increasing demand for GPUs, particularly for AI applications. The Japanese government is actively seeking investment opportunities in the production of advanced semiconductors, vital for emerging technologies. Reports indicate that the Japanese government has allocated billions of dollars to support Nvidia's rival, TSMC.

Sri Lankan government offers \$1.7 billion solar project to Australian firm

The Sri Lankan government has proposed a significant \$1.7 billion solar project to Australia's United Solar Energy, for a 700MW wind power plant in northern Sri Lanka. This initiative is part of the government's strategy to diversify the country's energy grid and address the economic crisis faced in the previous year. The facility will be situated in the northern Kilinochchi district. It will be the largest renewable energy project for Sri Lanka.



EV registrations outpace diesel in European Union

A European Automobile Manufacturers' Association (ACEA) report has revealed that battery-electric car registrations increased by 36.3% in October 2023 as compared to October 2022. In numbers, a total of 121,808 units were registered during October 2023. On the other hand, the diesel car market continued to decline, and year-on-year (YoY), it fell 13.2%. A total of 1.2 million new EVs were sold in the EU so far in 2023, till the time of reporting. This indicates a growth of 53.1% over last year. EVs now hold 14% market share of total cars sold in the EU.

New York signs a \$10 billion project for sub-2nm chip fab

New York has recently shared a collaboration plan with IBM, Micron, and other industry players to invest \$10 billion to expand the Albany NanoTech Complex into a new high numerical aperture extreme ultraviolet lithography (High NA EUV) centre. The centre will have an ASML machine to produce microchips at sizes smaller than 2 nanometres. The machine will employ advanced laser technology, extending beyond the ultraviolet spectrum, to meticulously etch intricate circuitry pathways on an incredibly minute scale.

British Petroleum takes over solar developer Lightsource BP

BP plans to utilise Lightsource BP's expertise as a developer of cost-effective utility-scale onshore renewable power to meet its own low carbon power needs. This integration is expected to support and mitigate risks in achieving BP's ambitious goals in

its transition growth areas, including hydrogen, electric vehicle charging, biofuels, and power trading.

Valeo hits 20 million production mark for Mobileye-equipped front cameras

Valeo, a leader in advanced driving assistance systems (ADAS), has reached a notable milestone by producing 20 million front camera systems featuring Mobileye technology, following their 10 millionth camera in November 2022. The partnership with Mobileye started in 2015, with Valeo incorporating Mobileye's 'EyeQ' system-on-chip (SoC) into its camera systems. The front camera systems boost road safety by supporting features like emergency braking, adaptive cruise control, lane-keeping assist, and traffic sign recognition.

Siemens, Intel partner to boost chip industry and sustainability

Siemens and Intel have partnered to enhance semiconductor manufacturing efficiency and sustainability of microelectronics manufacturing. The partnership will be focused on improving



future manufacturing methods, evolving factory operations, and cybersecurity, and backing a resilient international industry ecosystem. Siemens will bring its portfolio of IoT-enabled hardware, software, and electrical equipment to this collaboration.

ASML teams up with Samsung, SK hynix for research lab

ASML has announced its first-ever offshore research lab, which will be set up in South Korea in collaboration with Samsung, to develop cutting-edge chip processing technology using next-generation EUV (extreme ultraviolet lithography) equipment. The investment in this lab will be approx. \$750 million. Besides Samsung, SK hynix will also work with ASML to reduce the energy consumption of EUV machines.

Valorem announces 300MW solar deal with T&T Proenergy

Valorem, a France-based independent green energy operator, has partnered with T&T Proenergy, a Polish solar developer and contractor, to work jointly on a substantial 300MW portfolio of photovoltaic (PV) projects in Poland. This strategic alliance aims to bolster Valorem's position in the European renewable energy independent power producer (IPP) market by leveraging T&T Proenergy's deep understanding of the local market and their close relationships with local authorities. The scope of the agreement encompasses the entire project development process, starting from the early stages and continuing until the projects attain a 'ready-to-build' status.